PRINTABLE PARTY GAME · 8 PUZZLES · TEAMS OF 2 TO 20

THE SNOWBOUND LODGE

Christmas Escape Room for Adults

Eight linked puzzles. Each answer opens the next lock. For teens, office parties and game night.

1. The Keeper's Letter
2. The Frosted Window
3. The Card Box
4. The Grandfather Clock
5. The Guest Register
6. The Ornament Scale
7. The Storm Telegram
8. The Gift Vault

US LETTER PDF · PRINT AT HOME · 45 TO 60 MIN

GM's Digital Creations

Host Guide

HOST ONLY

Read this page alone. It explains the game without giving away any answers.

STORY TO READ ALOUD

Read aloud: "The storm closed the mountain road at noon. The keeper of the Snowbound Lodge left before it hit, but every present for tonight's party is locked in the gift vault. The keeper left a trail: eight locks, each opened by the answer to the one before. You have sixty minutes before the fire burns out. Find the vault code."

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Print one full set per team (pages 3 to 11).
2. Cut the hint cards apart; keep them face down.
3. Give each team Puzzle 1, the Lock Sheet and a pencil.
4. Hand out the next puzzle only when a team shows you the right answer.
5. A team may ask for a hint card; each hint adds 2 minutes.
6. First team to the vault code with the best time wins.

BEFORE GUESTS ARRIVE

- [ ] Print on plain US Letter paper
- [ ] Put each puzzle in a numbered envelope
- [ ] Set a 60-minute timer you can show
- [ ] Keep the answer key (page 14) out of sight
- [ ] Pencils and scrap paper for every team
- [ ] Optional: a small prize in a box for the vault

PLAYERS	TEAMS	TIME	LEVEL
2 to 20	2 to 5 each	45 to 60 min	Teens + adults

1 · The Keeper's Letter

A note waits on the kitchen table, under a mug of cold cider.

ON THE KITCHEN TABLE

Dear guests,

Snow came early this year, and the road up to the lodge closed by noon.

Hot cider is on the stove, and the fire should last until morning.

I had to leave before the storm, so every gift is locked in the vault.

Find your way in, and the gifts are yours to open tonight.

The window, the card box and the old clock each hold a piece of the way in.

Begin at the frosted window beside the front door.

You will see that the letters there have slipped out of place.

Nothing in this lodge is random, not even this letter.

If you get stuck, your host has hint cards for every room.

Not every clue looks like a clue at first glance.

Enjoy the night, and save me a slice of pie.

The Keeper

What number does the letter give you?

Unlocks Puzzle 2: The Frosted Window

2 · The Frosted Window

Letters are scratched into the frost on the glass.

THE SCENE

Someone wrote a message in the frost, but every letter has slipped forward along the alphabet by the same number of places. Your answer to Puzzle 1 tells you how far. Slide each letter back to read it. The alphabet wraps: one back from A is Z.

THE GLASS

C	Q	N

L	J	A	M

K	X	G

T	N	H	F	X	A	M

R	B

Y	R	W	N

ALPHABET STRIP: COUNT BACK ALONG IT

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13

N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

What is the keyword?

Unlocks Puzzle 3: The Card Box

3 · The Card Box

A wooden recipe box with a brass letter grid glued inside the lid.

THE SCENE

The top card is in a keyword cipher. Write your Puzzle 2 keyword under it, over and over. For each pair: find the keyword letter's row in the grid, run along to the card's letter, then look up. The column's top letter is the real one.

CARD	H	B	B	T		I	P	R		G	A	W	P	O		P	B		E	S	L		A	V	B
KEY																								
REAL																								

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
A	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
B	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A
C	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B
D	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C
E	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D
F	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E
G	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F
H	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
I	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
J	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
K	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
L	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K
M	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
N	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
O	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N
P	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O
Q	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P
R	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q
S	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R
T	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S
U	U	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T
V	V	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U
W	W	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V
X	X	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W
Y	Y	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X
Z	Z	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y

Which row of the clock should you read?

Unlocks Puzzle 4: The Grandfather Clock

4 · The Grandfather Clock

The clock face has been swapped for a grid of numbered tiles.

THE SCENE

Fill the grid so every row, every column and every bold 2 x 3 block holds the numbers 1 to 6 once each. Each row has three shaded tiles. Read the shaded tiles in the row your Puzzle 3 answer names, left to right: that three-digit number is a guest room.

THE CLOCK FACE

Row 1		2	5			
Row 2	3				2	
Row 3	4		3	6	1	
Row 4	2					
Row 5			2			5
Row 6		6				

Which room number did the clock give?

Unlocks Puzzle 5: The Guest Register

5 · The Guest Register

Four guests signed the book, and each wrapped one present.

THE REGISTER NOTES

1. Margo has the lowest room number.
2. The candle was wrapped in room 204.
3. The scarf was wrapped in room 421.
4. Felix wrapped neither the scarf nor the candle.
5. Dexter's room number is lower than Felix's.
6. Iris did not wrap the scarf.
7. The snow globe was wrapped in room 231.

GUESTS AND ROOMS

Margo, Felix, Iris and Dexter. Rooms: 204, 231, 421 and 536. Presents: a scarf, a candle, a snow globe and mittens. Each guest has one room and wrapped one present.

Who is staying in the room the clock gave you?

WORKING GRID: MARK X FOR NO, O FOR YES

	204	231	421	536	Scarf	Candle	Globe	Mittens
Margo								
Felix								
Iris								
Dexter								

Name of the guest in that room

Unlocks Puzzle 6: The Ornament Scale

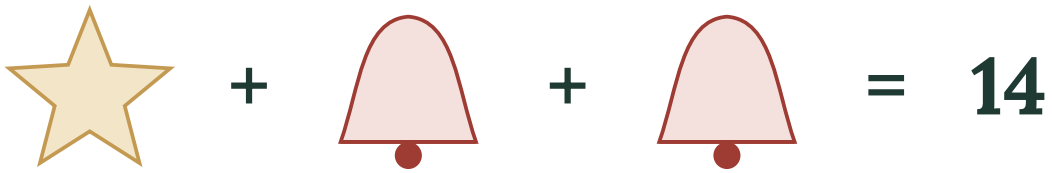
6 · The Ornament Scale

A brass scale on the mantel, with ornaments in place of weights.

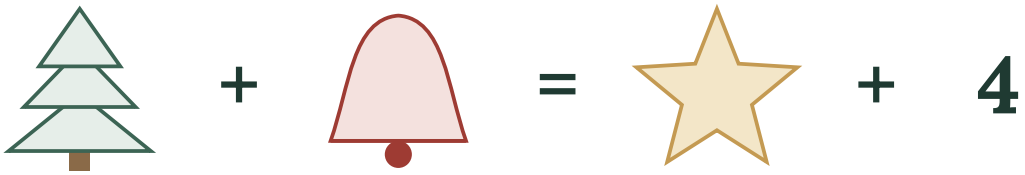
THE SCENE

Each kind of ornament always weighs the same whole number. On its own the scale has too many answers. The keeper's tag says: the star weighs as much as the number of letters in the name you found in Puzzle 5.

PAN 1



PAN 2



YOUR TURN



Tree + star = ?

Unlocks Puzzle 7: The Storm Telegram

7 · The Storm Telegram

A telegram slip came through before the line went dead. It looks like noise.

THE SCENE

Your Puzzle 6 answer is the step. Start on the very first letter, then count forward that many letters each time, reading across each row and on to the next. Write each letter you land on below. The message tells you how to open the vault.

THE TELEGRAM

1	R	I	L	Y	V	R	A	O	H	V	B	F	D	L	O	H
2	M	S	D	T	H	M	G	N	I	F	M	F	N	E	U	U
3	O	E	E	U	A	G	G	F	F	J	M	G	S	W	V	G
4	F	B	G	M	J	A	L	N	E	E	I	C	K	J	U	R
5	A	U	W	Y	K	C	T	L	J	P	Y	K	F	I	P	Y
6	F	B	I	A	M	M	A	S	N	L	M	E	A	O	B	Y
7	F	U	S	D	H	O	L	R	L	N	I	O	D	T	L	J
8	I	N	C	G	K	R	U	N	E	K	I	Y	S	C	E	W

THE HIDDEN MESSAGE

Write the instruction in the cells above

Unlocks Puzzle 8: The Gift Vault

8 · The Gift Vault

A heavy green door behind the tree, with four brass number wheels.

THE SCENE

Follow the telegram's instruction using the answers on your Lock Sheet. The result is a four-digit number. Set it on the wheels below and show your host. A brass plate under the dial reads: the four digits add up to 18.

THE VAULT DOOR



The vault code

Opens the vault: stop the clock!

Lock Sheet

TEAM RECORD

One per team. Write each answer as you solve it; your host checks it before the next envelope.

Team name _____

LOCK 1
The Keeper's Letter
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

LOCK 2
The Frosted Window
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

LOCK 3
The Card Box
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

LOCK 4
The Grandfather Clock
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

LOCK 5
The Guest Register
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

LOCK 6
The Ornament Scale
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

LOCK 7
The Storm Telegram
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

LOCK 8
The Gift Vault
ANSWER _____ TIME _____

Hint Cards

HOST: CUT OUT

Cut along the dashed lines. Fold each card so Hint 2 stays hidden until a team needs it.

HINT · PUZZLE 1

The Keeper's Letter

1. The message is not in what the letter says.

fold here

2. Read the first letter of every line, top to bottom.

HINT · PUZZLE 2

The Frosted Window

1. Each glass letter moved forward the same number of places.

fold here

2. Slide every letter back by your Puzzle 1 number. C becomes T.

HINT · PUZZLE 3

The Card Box

1. Line up the keyword under the card: P I N E P I N E ...

fold here

2. First pair: row P, find H in that row, look up to the top letter.

HINT · PUZZLE 4

The Grandfather Clock

1. Start with the blocks that already hold four numbers.

fold here

2. Your Puzzle 3 answer is a row number. Read only that row's shaded tiles.

HINT · PUZZLE 5

The Guest Register

1. Margo's room is fixed by note 1. Note 2 then gives her present.

fold here

2. Felix cannot be in 421, and Dexter must be lower than Felix.

HINT · PUZZLE 6

The Ornament Scale

1. Count the letters in the Puzzle 5 name to weigh the star.

fold here

2. Pan 1 then gives the bell. Pan 2 gives the tree.

HINT · PUZZLE 7

The Storm Telegram

1. The step is your Puzzle 6 answer. The first letter counts.

fold here

2. Letters 1, 8, 15, 22 and so on. The message starts with R.

HINT · PUZZLE 8

The Gift Vault

1. The telegram names two answers from your Lock Sheet.

fold here

2. Multiply them. Check: the four digits add up to 18.

Team Timer & Scores

Write the clock time when each team opens a lock. Each hint card adds 2 minutes.

HOW THE FINAL TIME WORKS

Final time = minutes from start to vault + 2 minutes for each hint card used. The lowest final time wins. If no team opens the vault in 60 minutes, the team with the most locks open wins; ties go to fewer hints.

Example: vault opened at 41 min, 3 hint cards used = 41 + 6 = 47 min final time

TEAM	START	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7	VAULT	HINTS	FINAL	PLACE

Answer Key

HOST ONLY

Host only. Fold this page away before the game starts.

THE FULL CLUE CHAIN

1 The Keeper's Letter — **9**
First letters spell SHIFT BY NINE.

2 The Frosted Window — **PINE**
CQN LJAM KXG TNHFXAM RB YRWN back 9 = THE CARD BOX KEYWORD IS PINE.

3 The Card Box — **6**
HBBT IPR GAWPO PB ESL AVB with key PINE = STOP THE CLOCK AT ROW SIX.

4 The Grandfather Clock — **231**
Row 6 of the solved grid: 5 6 4 2 3 1. Shaded tiles read 231.

5 The Guest Register — **IRIS**
Margo 204 candle, Iris 231 snow globe, Dexter 421 scarf, Felix 536 mittens.

6 The Ornament Scale — **7**
Star 4 (I-R-I-S), bell 5, tree 3. Tree + star = 7.

7 The Storm Telegram — **Room x 9**
Every 7th letter from the first: ROOM NUMBER TIMES NINE.

8 The Gift Vault — **2079**
231 x 9 = 2079. Digits add to 18.

SOLVED CLOCK GRID (PUZZLE 4)

6	2	5	1	4	3
3	4	1	5	2	6
4	5	3	6	1	2
2	1	6	3	5	4
1	3	2	4	6	5
5	6	4	2	3	1

Every answer in the chain was checked by a script before printing: the grid has one solution, the register has one solution, and the scale has one solution once the star is known.

Certificate of Escape

PRINT ONE PER TEAM



THIS CERTIFIES THAT TEAM

escaped the

Snowbound Lodge

and opened the gift vault before the fire burned out.

FINAL TIME

HINTS USED

DATE

SIGNED BY THE HOST



You just made my day!

Thank you for choosing a small, one-person shop over the big guys.

Quick favor? If this made your party or planning even a little easier, a 30-second review helps the next family find it. I read every single one.

How: Etsy app → You → Purchases → Leave a review

Something not right? Message me first and I'll fix it fast.

With thanks,

GM's Digital Creations